

COURSE SYLLABUS
IST 782 DS/AI PORTFOLIO

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Instructor: Ying Lin, Ph.D.

Email: ylin65@syr.edu

Course Description:

IST 782: DS/AI Portfolio is a 1-credit course for students completing the M.S. in Applied Data Science or Applied Human-Centered AI. This course emphasizes critical reflection on the knowledge and skills developed throughout the program, encouraging students to articulate both their academic growth and professional aspirations. Final deliverables—including a written reflection, website portfolio, and brief presentation—demonstrate each student's ability to communicate actionable insights, integrate technical skills, and plan for future contributions in the field of AI and/or data science.

Prerequisite / Co-requisite:

Students must have completed (or will complete during this semester/term) 75% of their program

Audience:

Graduate students completing the MS Applied Data Science program or the MS Applied Human-Centered AI program.

Credits:

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Learning Objectives:

After taking this course, the students will be able to:

1. **Reflect critically on their academic experiences** to explain how hands-on projects contributed to achieving their program learning outcomes.
2. **Communicate the program's learning objectives** and demonstrate how selected coursework and projects reflect mastery of key technical and analytical skills.
3. **Develop and present a professional portfolio** that synthesizes their academic work and articulates their evolving identity and future goals as data science practitioners.

Texts / Supplies – Required:

There is no text book required for the class. Reading will be assigned within the Learning Management System

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Course Requirements and Expectations:

Throughout the semester, you will complete a series of structured assignments designed to help you reflect on your learning, synthesize your experiences, and build your professional portfolio. These include short written reflections based on curated video insights (“Guest Insights”) and guided writing and discussion tasks (“Portfolio Builder Assignments”). Each activity is designed to help you connect your coursework to the program’s learning outcomes, while also encouraging you to articulate your strengths, ethical perspectives, and future goals.

These assignments are designed to guide your thinking and help generate the content you'll use in your final portfolio. Hence, you are encouraged to leverage your assignment responses to create a compelling final portfolio.

There will also be one face-to-face session partly through the semester. This session will help you connect the reflection work you’ve begun with the final portfolio goals. We’ll review common challenges, look at sample portfolios, and discuss strategies for organizing your own work. Bring questions and project ideas—this is your chance to calibrate before final portfolio development begins.

Instructions are provided for each task. Unless otherwise stated, your initial response is due by 11:59 PM of the assigned day, with any required peer responses due 3 days later (also at 11:59 PM).

Grading: Each assignment is graded on thoughtfulness, completeness, and engagement with the prompt (and peers, where applicable). Late posts may not be counted unless previously arranged.

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Reminder: Be respectful and constructive in all public responses. This is a professional space to build your reflective and communication skills.

Course Deliverables: Grading / Schedule:

Activity	Date	Expected time allocated	Expected Contribution	Points
Live Group Session (9:30am)	1/25	Live participation	Graded in class activities	4
Guest Insight 1 - Portfolio Ideas	1/30	Video: 12 min + Reflection: 20 min	~250 words	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 1 – Your AI/ Data Science Identity	1/30	Writing: 90 min	~300-400 words	4
Guest Insight 2 - Reframing Projects	2/13	Video: 12 min + Reflection: 20 min	~250-300 words	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 2 - Non-Technical Summary	2/13	Post: 45 min + Replies: 30 min	Post: ~300 words; Replies: ~100 each	4
Guest Insight 3 – standing out	2/20	Video: 12 min + Outline: 20 min	~200-300 words or bullets	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 3 - Effective Portfolios	2/20	Post: 30 min + Reply: 45 min	Post: ~300 words; Reply: ~100 words	4
Guest Insight 4 - Elevator Pitch	2/27	Video: 9 min + Writing: 20 min	~150-200 words	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 4 - Ethics in Practice	2/27	Writing: 90 min	~400-500 words	4
Guest Insight 5 - Communicating Achievements	3/6	Video: 18 min + Writing: 45 min	~300-400 words	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 5 - Synthesis Across Courses	3/6	Post: 45 min + Reply: 30 min	Post: ~350 words; Reply: ~100 words	4
Guest Insight 6 - Value of Reflection	3/13	Video: 12 min + Writing: 20 min	~300 words	2
Portfolio Builder Assignment 6 - Track Reflection	3/13	Writing: 90 min	~300-400 words	4
Portfolio Web Site	4/17		See specific assignment	20
Portfolio Reflection paper	4/24		See specific assignment	40

Reading (optional)

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How to Make a College Student Career Portfolio

<https://work.chron.com/make-college-student-career-portfolio-12837.html>

Grading Table

Grades	Grade Points /Credit	Percentage Range	Total Points
A	4.000	93% - 100%	93-100
A-	3.66	90% - 92%	90-92
B+	3.33	87% - 89%	87-89
B	3.00	83% - 86%	83-86
B-	2.66	80% - 82%	80-82
C+	2.33	77% - 79%	77-79
C	2.00	73% - 76%	73-76
C-	1.66	70% - 72%	70-72
F	0	0% - 69%	0-69

SYRACUSE UNIVERSITY STUDENT POLICIES & SERVICES

iSchool Values

Excellence; Discovery & Innovation; Integrity; Diversity & Inclusion; Global Citizenship and Engagement

Syracuse University has a variety of policies designed to guarantee that students live and study in a community respectful of their needs and those of fellow students. These statements are an official part of this course syllabus.

University Attendance Policy

Attendance in classes is expected in all courses at Syracuse University. Students are expected to arrive on campus in time to attend the first meeting of all classes for which they are registered. Students who do not attend classes starting with the first scheduled meeting may be academically withdrawn as not making progress toward degree by failure to attend.

Academic Integrity Policy

As a pre-eminent and inclusive student-focused research institution, Syracuse University considers academic integrity at the forefront of learning, serving as a core value and guiding pillar of education. Syracuse University's Academic Integrity Policy provides students with the

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necessary guidelines to complete academic work with integrity throughout their studies. Students are required to uphold both course-specific and university-wide academic integrity expectations such as crediting your sources, doing your own work, communicating honestly, and supporting academic integrity. The full Syracuse University Academic Integrity Policy can be found by visiting class.syr.edu, selecting, “Academic Integrity,” and “Expectations and Policy.”

Upholding Academic Integrity includes the protection of faculty’s intellectual property. Students should not upload, distribute, or share instructors’ course materials, including presentations, assignments, exams, or other evaluative materials without permission. Using websites that charge fees or require uploading of course material (e.g., Chegg, Course Hero) to obtain exam solutions or assignments completed by others, which are then presented as your own violates academic integrity expectations in this course and may be classified as a Level 3 violation. All academic integrity expectations that apply to in-person assignments, quizzes, and exams also apply online.

Students found in violation of the policy are subject to grade sanctions determined by the course instructor and non-grade sanctions determined by the School or College where the course is offered. Students may not drop or withdraw from courses in which they face a suspected violation. Any established violation in this course may result in course failure regardless of violation level.

Use of Artificial Intelligence in Course

All generative-AI tools are prohibited in this course because their use inhibits achievement of the course learning objectives. This policy applies to all stages of project and writing processes including researching, brainstorming, outlining, organizing, and polishing. Do not use Generative-AI tools to create any content (i.e., images and video, audio, text, code, etc.). If you have any questions about a feature and whether it is considered Generative-AI, ask your instructor.

Academic Integrity Online: Conduct of Online Assessments

All academic integrity expectations that apply to in-person quizzes and exams also apply to online quizzes and exams. In this course, all work submitted for quizzes and exams must be yours alone. Discussing quiz or exam questions with anyone during the quiz or exam period violates academic integrity expectations for this course.

Using websites that charge fees or require uploading of course material (e.g., Chegg, Course Hero) to obtain exam solutions or assignments completed by others and present the work as your own violates academic integrity expectations in this course and may be classified as a Level 3 violation, resulting in suspension or expulsion from Syracuse University

Religious Observances Notification and Policy

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[Syracuse University's Religious Observances Policy](#) recognizes the diversity of faiths represented in the campus community and protects the rights of students, faculty, and staff to observe religious holy days according to their traditions. Under the policy, students are given an opportunity to make up any examination, study, or work requirements that may be missed due to a religious observance, provided they notify their instructors no later than the academic drop deadline. For observances occurring before the drop deadline, notification is required at least two academic days in advance. Students may enter their observances in MySlice under Student Services/Enrollment/My Religious Observances/Add a Notification.

Disability-Related Accommodations

Syracuse University values diversity and inclusion; we are committed to a climate of mutual respect and full participation. There may be aspects of the instruction or design of this course that result in barriers to your inclusion and full participation in this course. I invite any student to contact me to discuss strategies and/or accommodations (academic adjustments) that may be essential to your success and to collaborate with the Center for Disability Resources (CDR) in this process.

If you would like to discuss disability-accommodations or register with CDR, please visit [Center for Disability Resources](#). Please call (315) 443-4498 or email disabilityresources@syr.edu for more detailed information.

The CDR is responsible for coordinating disability-related academic accommodations and will work with the student to develop an access plan. Since academic accommodations may require early planning and generally is not provided retroactively, please contact CDR as soon as possible to begin this process.

Discrimination or Harassment

Federal and state law, and University policy prohibit discrimination and harassment based on sex or gender (including sexual harassment, sexual assault, domestic/dating violence, stalking, sexual exploitation, and retaliation). If a student has been harassed or assaulted, they can obtain confidential counseling support, 24-hours a day, 7 days a week, from the [Sexual and Relationship Violence Response Team](#) at the Counseling Center (315-443-8000, Barnes Center at The Arch, 150 Sims Drive, Syracuse, New York 13244). Incidents of sexual violence or harassment can be reported non-confidentially to the University's Title IX Officer (Sheila Johnson Willis, 315-443-0211, titleix@syr.edu, 005 Steele Hall). Reports to law enforcement can be made to the University's Department of Public Safety (315-443-2224, 005 Sims Hall), the Syracuse Police Department (511 South State Street, Syracuse, New York, 911 in case of emergency or 315-435-3016 to speak with the Abused Persons Unit), or the State Police (844-845-7269). I will seek to keep information you share with me private to the greatest extent possible, but as a professor I have mandatory reporting responsibilities to share information regarding sexual misconduct, harassment, and crimes I learn about with the University's Title IX Officer to help make our campus a safer place for all.

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Health and Wellness

Mental health and overall well-being are significant predictors of academic success. As such it is essential that during your college experience you develop the skills and resources effectively to navigate stress, anxiety, depression, and other mental health concerns. Please familiarize yourself with the range of resources the Barnes Center provides (<https://ese.syr.edu/bewell/>) and seek out support for mental health concerns as needed. Counseling services are available 24/7, 365 days, at 315-443-8000.

Course Evaluations

At the end of the term, the iSchool will ask you to share course feedback through [EvaluationKIT](https://coursefeedback.syr.edu) [https://coursefeedback.syr.edu]. Log in to [EvaluationKIT](https://coursefeedback.syr.edu) using your NetID and password. Please take the time to share your feedback about this course and your experience in it; all ratings and comments are completely anonymous. The iSchool carefully reviews your feedback. Our instructors use this feedback to fine tune course delivery and instruction; our professors of record use this feedback to fine tune course content and assignments. All feedback is factored into iSchool decisions about course, program, and instructor development.

Use of Blackboard

This class will use the Blackboard Learning Management to house the syllabus, course content, links to external course materials, assignments, quizzes, exams, feedback, and grades. Note when submitting materials that the University's Blackboard Learning Management System is on Eastern Time.

Information about Blackboard is available on [Answers Blackboard](#); alternatively, you can contact Information Technology Services by sending an email to help@syr.edu, calling 315.443.2677, or in-person at the ITS Service Center, located at 1-227 CST in the Life Sciences Complex. Business hours for the Service Center can be found on the ITS Website at http://its.syr.edu/its_service_center/

Academic work

Academic work completed during a semester may be used by professors for educational purposes in courses during the semester. Students' registration and continued enrollment constitute consent for this purpose. Before using students' work for educational purposes in subsequent semesters, professors will either request students' permission in writing or render the work anonymous by removing all personal identification.

This class will use the plagiarism detection and prevention system Turnitin. You will have the option to submit your papers to Turnitin to check that all sources you use have been properly acknowledged and cited before you submit the paper to me. I will also submit all papers you write for this class to Turnitin, which compares submitted documents against documents on the Internet and against student papers submitted to Turnitin at Syracuse University and at other colleges and universities. I will take your knowledge of the subject matter of this course and

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your writing level and style into account in interpreting the originality report. Keep in mind that all papers you submit for this class will become part of the [Turnitin.com](https://turnitin.com) reference database solely for the purpose of detecting plagiarism of such papers.